

Whitman College Departmental Social Media Guidelines

Account management and password sharing

Every account should have at least two designated staff/faculty password keepers, responsible for securely storing and updating account passwords as needed.

Revoke access for any staff, faculty or student who no longer requires it as part of their role as soon as possible and change passwords as needed.

Student access

Student access should be limited and monitored to prevent messaging that goes against the college/department guidelines. Students should be briefed on guidelines before being granted access. After the student's access period ends, change the password to maintain account security.

Creating and managing a campus account

Before creating a new social media account for your department, consider the following: What type of content will you share? How frequently will you post? Who will manage the account? Is this the best way to reach your intended audience? Also, think about whether this information could be better shared through Whitman Today instead.

When naming your social media account, avoid starting the handle with "Whitman" to prevent confusion with the college's primary accounts. Instead, incorporate "Whitman" as a secondary component in the name. For example, @bonappetitwhitman.

Consider Your Audience: Understanding your audience will help you choose the best platform for your account and effectively reach your intended audience.

Prospective Students: Instagram and TikTok are popular among younger demographics, including prospective students. Whitman's Communication Office prefers to manage messaging for prospective students through the main Whitman accounts and discourages any new campus accounts for this purpose.

Current Students and Campus Community: For communicating with current students, staff, and faculty, it's best to use existing campus channels like WhitmanToday and campus listservs. These platforms offer direct and effective communication.

If you prefer, and are able to maintain your own channel, Instagram and Tik Tok are an effective way to reach current students, staff and faculty. Please adhere to the social media guidelines to ensure content aligns with Whitman College's core messaging.

Local Community and Whitman Families: Consider Facebook to reach this audience. Maintain social media guidelines and best practices.

Alumni: The best way to reach alumni is by submitting content to the Alumni Relations Office. Facebook is also a useful platform for connecting with this audience. Maintain social media guidelines and best practices.

Utilizing Whitman Today to share information across campus

All submissions to WhitmanToday are welcome! Publicize campus events, share content, or celebrate an accomplishment or submit photo finishes to be featured in Whitman Today by emailing whitmantoday@whitman.edu.

To include an event on the website calendar, visit calendar.whitman.edu, scroll to the bottom of the page, and click "Submit an Event" to complete the form. Once approved, the event will automatically be added to the Whitman Today calendar as well.

Note: If you'd like an announcement made for the event, you'll need to email Whitman Today.

Content Guidelines

Now that your account is up and running, think about the content you'll be sharing. You have the flexibility to represent your department as you see fit, but here are some ideas to help you get started:

- **Event Announcements:** upcoming events, workshops, or tabling sessions your department is hosting. Be sure to post with plenty of notice to give your audience time to plan.
- **Share helpful tips, resources, and department updates** that are relevant to students, staff, and faculty.
- **Photos** are a great way to make your content more engaging. Share images from events, office activities, or everyday moments around your department. Capture students or groups in action, showcase your office or building, and share updates.
- **Use stories** to give your audience real-time updates into ongoing activities or events.
- **Reposting:** an easy way to maintain regular communication is by reposting relevant quotes, graphics, and photos from other accounts to your stories.

Content to Avoid: These guidelines apply to both content you post and content you reshare from other accounts.

- **Inappropriate Content:** Do not post anything that is inappropriate for a school or professional setting, including violence, drugs, alcohol, profanity, or nudity.
- **Sensitive Information:** Avoid sharing sensitive information without permission. This includes full names, contact information, or personal social media handles.
- **Inflammatory Language:** Steer clear of posting or resharing any content that includes words or phrases intended to provoke or offend, such as racist, homophobic, misogynistic, or Islamophobic remarks.
- **Misinformation:** Do not post or share content that is false or misleading. Ensure that the information you provide is accurate and fact-checked before sharing.
- **Commercial Promotion:** Avoid posting or resharing content that promotes commercial products or services.
- **Personal Opinions:** Refrain from posting personal opinions or political views that could be perceived as representing the college's stance.

Posting During Politically Heightened Times

As a non-profit institution, Whitman College must adhere to strict legal guidelines regarding political activity. Federal law prohibits tax-exempt institutions from engaging in partisan political activities. This restriction is especially critical during an election cycle to avoid risks like loss of tax-exempt status, additional taxes, lawsuits, audits, or investigations.

While we encourage students to think critically and form their own opinions, the college **cannot endorse or oppose any political candidates or parties for any public office.**

To navigate political participation this election season, follow these guidelines:

- It is permissible to take positions on public policy issues, but tax laws prohibit any issue advocacy expressing favor or opposition to a candidate.
- Promote nonpartisan civic engagement, such as voter education activities or initiatives that align with the college's values, like environmental sustainability or social justice.
- Avoid any promotion of candidates, political parties, or activities that could be perceived as the college favoring or opposing any specific candidate or party.
- Individuals working for the college are free to express personal political beliefs, but not in a way that implies official college endorsement.

Please review Whitman College's institutional responsibility guidelines carefully and refer to section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code for more detailed information.

Connecting with Whitman's main channels

Whitman's main social media channels include Instagram, Facebook, Twitter (X), LinkedIn, YouTube, and TikTok. Our primary audience is prospective students, parents, and alumni. We love to share content from other campus accounts, so be sure to tag @WhitmanCollege in any posts or stories.

Additionally, feel free to share Whitman news, student and faculty achievements, and alumni stories with the Communications Office for potential features on our main channels, the Newsroom or the Whitman Magazine.

Whitman Hashtags: #Whitmancollege #TheWorldNeedsWhitties ##WhittieLife #OfficiallyWhittie #WhitmanScholar #WhitmanClassof2028 #WhitmanClassof2024 #WallaWalla #WallaWallaWashington

Contact Us

Heidi Pitts, Assistant Director of Digital Marketing and Media: pittsh@whitman.edu

Margie Reece, Director of Content: reecemk@whitman.edu

Esmeralda Marin, Social Media Specialist: marine@whitman.edu